

Chapter 153-1

This evening banquet had gathered the elite of Haizhou City.

Using charity as a pretext to make connections.

Everyone who came knew that Old Master Qin was advanced in years, and the Qin family's branch lineages were tangled and complex. On the surface, Qin Liushuang was in charge, but there were still many juniors in the Qin Corporation eyeing the position covetously.

And there was also Qin Lishuang, who acted recklessly relying on Old Master Qin's favor.

No one knew whose hands the Qin family would ultimately fall into.

So everyone present was watching and waiting.

Zhao Xuning was also among those invited.

She originally had no intention of coming, but after hearing from her sister that people from both the Shen and Gu families would be attending, she rushed over after finishing a surgery, going home to shower and change into formal attire.

As the second young miss of the Zhao family who rarely made public appearances, Zhao Xuning didn't need to be busy socializing like her sister, holding a wine glass and maneuvering through the crowd.

After arriving, she found a quiet corner to sit in, undisturbed.

She did see Liang Shi and Xu Qingzhu though.

At such an evening banquet, Xu Qingzhu naturally had things to do, unlike idle people like her.

So she only sent a message to Liang Shi: 【Northwest.】

Brief and to the point.

When Liang Shi saw the message, she quickly understood her meaning, and their gazes met across the room.

But Liang Shi replied: 【Busy tonight.】

Zhao Xuning: 【.....】

Unable to find a companion to hang out with, Zhao Xuning stayed quietly by herself.

Beneath the surface of this seemingly calm evening banquet, undercurrents were surging.

Before long, Zhao Xuning went outside to get some fresh air.

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Zhao Xuning didn't expect to run into Shen Hui's older sister outside.

The other woman was standing in a corner against the wall, making a phone call, her voice cold and low.

Between leaving and staying, she decisively chose to leave.

But before she could take two steps, she met the other woman's gaze head-on.

The other woman wore a watch with a very thin band, likely a high-end custom piece, looking quite valuable.

A simple white shirt and black trousers were worn by her with an air of expensive luxury. Even in the slightly cold outdoors, her shirt sleeves were still rolled up a bit.

She looked shrewd and capable.

Suddenly feeling the awkwardness of being caught, Zhao Xuning nodded slightly at her.

But Shen Fenghe suddenly spoke: "Zhao Xuning?"

Having been called by name, she naturally couldn't pretend not to see her anymore.

Zhao Xuning's footsteps halted. "Mm."

Shen Fenghe had already walked closer to her and said calmly and directly: "Shen Hui didn't come tonight."

Having her thoughts exposed, Zhao Xuning stiffened and immediately said: "I wasn't..."

Before she could finish, Shen Fenghe interrupted her with a firm tone: "She doesn't participate in any company matters."

This kind of banquet was company business.

Zhao Xuning didn't know what Shen Fenghe's intentions were in saying these things.

The narrowness and sense of oppression from back when they were abroad returned. She was about the same height as Shen Fenghe, and looked straight at her, feigning composure: "Miss Shen, what do you mean by that?"

"What I mean is..." Shen Fenghe paused, and her gaze toward Zhao Xuning suddenly became sharp and piercing, "Give up."

Cold without a trace of warmth.

As if she knew they had been in love for many years, and so even after breaking up, it was hard to let go.

Shen Fenghe spoke in an extremely calm tone, her eyes conveying only one message—there's no need to make excuses to me, I know everything.

There were no questions or interrogations. Just like when she went abroad to bring Shen Hui back, she didn't curse at her, nor did she hurl any insults or abuse, nor did she make any personal attacks. She simply said three words calmly to Zhao Xuning: "Break it off."

After that, there was no room for negotiation.

This time was exactly the same as back then.

After a moment, Zhao Xuning asked her: "Did Shen Hui ask you to say this to me?"

"She doesn't know." Shen Fenghe was also very honest, composed and calm, as if she were handling business matters, seemingly at ease with everything. "I just happened to run into you, so I'm kindly giving you a reminder."

Zhao Xuning paused. "President Shen and I don't seem to have the kind of relationship where we can get along so amicably."

"Mm." Shen Fenghe was blunt. "You can see it as my rare kindness, or you can see it as... me leaving you some dignity."

Zhao Xuning: "..."

The edge that had been restrained for so long now showed itself slightly. "What if I insist?"

Shen Fenghe's gaze swept lightly over her features, and she said calmly: "You can try."

"My father still doesn't know about you and Ah Hui." Shen Fenghe said, "My father has always been partial to Ah Hui. If he knew Ah Hui had suffered such grievances, there's no telling what he might do, and the Zhao family would suffer along with you."

"As far as I know, Mr. and Mrs. Zhao looked down on our Ah Hui back then." Shen Fenghe spoke unhurriedly, as if making casual conversation, but the aura she casually exuded made it clear she wasn't just making small talk. "If I have the chance to meet Mr. Zhao next time, I should ask him—in what way exactly is our Ah Hui not good enough for Miss Zhao?"

Seemingly calm, yet every word struck at the heart.

Zhao Xuning closed her eyes briefly. "President Shen, is this a threat?"

"It's not 'is this.'" Shen Fenghe said, "It is."

Zhao Xuning: "..."

"So what did you hear from Shen Hui?" Zhao Xuning asked in return lightly.

Shen Fenghe paused. "She's never mentioned anything since returning to the country."

"Then why do you think I'm a threat?" Zhao Xuning continued to press.

"Shen Hui is going on blind dates." Shen Fenghe didn't hide it. "If you appear in front of her frequently, it will make her unhappy."

Shen Fenghe lowered her head to glance at her watch, her speech quickening. "I don't want to see Ah Hui unhappy."

After saying this, she nodded with distant but polite courtesy: "I have other matters to attend to. I'll take my leave first."

Leaving Zhao Xuning standing there alone in a daze.

So, she was now an existence that would make Shen Hui unhappy.